

Bug defenses

Despite their best efforts, **sometimes bugs come under attack.** And when they do, they protect themselves in a host of incredible ways.

Chemical defenses

Lots of bugs release nasty chemicals to ward off attackers. When disturbed, some moths release foul-tasting bubbles.

Foul-tasting
bubbles

Amerila moth

Earthworms secrete mucus, a slimy substance that helps them slide through soil and away from enemies.

Earthworm

Noisemakers

Some cockroaches scare off their attackers by hissing. The loud noise is made by forcing air out through the breathing holes in the sides of their bodies.

*Madagascan
hissing cockroach*



Grasshopper

Losing legs

Some bugs, including grasshoppers, distract their attackers by dropping one of their legs! Many lucky bugs regrow lost legs after a few molts. A molt is when a bug sheds old skin to make way for new skin.